Dean Meiring

Data & BI Developer · SQL · Python · Automation · Machine Learning

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Final-year Bachelor of Computing student (Data Science, 65.6% weighted average) who builds and runs real data systems, not just coursework. I work daily in SQL, Python and BI tooling as an Application Specialist, and have deployed a live ML trading-signal platform and run a 30+ experiment ML research project. I enjoy turning messy data into decisions, I'm passionate about fintech, and I'm looking for a role where I can own problems end to end. Open to relocating to the UK, UAE, Poland, Portugal or Spain.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Computing (NQF Level 8), Data Science specialisation · Belgium Campus — Expected 2026
iTversity

- 4-year degree: 3 academic years plus a workplace year (internship and dissertation, in progress)
- Academic years: weighted average **65.6%** · 38 subjects passed, none failed
- Top results: Business Intelligence 84% · Innovation Management 82% · Project Management 80% · Capstone Project 76% · Database Administration 75%
- Relevant modules: Machine Learning, Statistics (3 years), Data Warehousing, Database Development, Linear Programming, Programming

EXPERIENCE

Application Specialist (AIT Intern) · Online Intelligence — Jan 2026 – Present

- Write SQL queries and automation scripts that replace manual data handling on the CiiMS platform for Thompsons Security Group, with support for Clicks and EBS Security
- Own end-to-end User Acceptance Testing for platform releases, turning client requirements into structured test coverage
- Work with the Regional Manager on platform configuration and client reporting in enterprise BI tooling

Co-Founder & Data Analyst · MEIDEAN Trading (family business) — Mar 2025 – Dec 2025

- Built custom software that automated day-to-day operations and business processes
- Delivered data analysis projects for external clients, including the Lipstar Group and Lancewood

Founder & Software Developer · LPSolutions — Oct 2023 – Dec 2024

- Ran my own software business, building custom applications for clients end to end, from requirements to delivery
- Built an application for a construction company client

Software Engineering Intern (Job Shadowing) · Pragma — Dec 2024

- Shadowed engineers on live industry software projects

IT Support (Part-Time) · Small start-up — 2022

- Provided troubleshooting and technical support in a fast-paced environment

KEY PROJECTS

Real-Time Crypto Arbitrage & ML Price-Prediction Platform

- Built and run a live trading-signal system on Railway: arbitrage detection across Binance and Crypto.com (WebSocket + REST) plus XGBoost models retrained daily on live market data for 8 assets (130K+ candles each)
- Found and fixed silent production bugs, including mislabelled training targets and a timestamp misalignment that broke live predictions for most assets
- Added a paper-trading engine with stop-loss/take-profit controls, a FastAPI + PostgreSQL dashboard and a Telegram bot for alerts; rigorous cross-validation showed the current model performs at chance (AUC ≈ 0.50), so I'm now testing order-book and on-chain features

Learned Feature Vocabularies for ML — independent research ·
github.com/DeanMeiring/features-abstractions-meaning

- Testing whether models can compress data into short, reusable “words” that other models can learn from, across 30+ pre-registered experiments (PyTorch, LightGBM) on churn, image, road-traffic and telecom datasets
- Compressed images to 8–49 bytes (up to 10.8x smaller than zipped pixels) while beating raw pixels by about 4 points with only 50 labels
- Set every success bar before running and judged results by 95% confidence intervals; published failures alongside wins

Mediterranean Fruit Fly Outbreak Prediction · github.com/DeanMeiring/Dean-Projects

- Built XGBoost classifiers predicting fruit fly outbreak risk for the Western Cape and California, each tuned to local climate, trap-catch and crop-cycle data
- Engineered features including cumulative degree-days, rainfall spikes, lagged trap counts, harvest schedules and distance to infestation hot spots
- Sourced and negotiated data access with international research bodies and industry contacts

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, SQL, JavaScript, TypeScript, Java, shell scripting
- **Data & BI:** Power BI, Tableau, Excel, data warehousing, dashboards and reporting
- **Machine Learning:** pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, XGBoost, LightGBM, PyTorch, feature engineering, model evaluation, confidence intervals
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, TimescaleDB, SQLite, relational and time-series design
- **Backend & Deployment:** FastAPI, asyncio, REST & WebSocket APIs, Git, Railway
- **Ways of working:** Agile, User Acceptance Testing, requirements gathering

LEADERSHIP & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Esports Tournament Organiser,** Belgium Campus: run inter-university Rocket League, Valorant and EA FC tournaments across South African campuses, including brackets, sponsorship and player analytics
- **Youth Ministry Leader,** Shofar Stellenbosch (Jan 2024 – Present): lead and mentor a youth group
- **Mission Trip Co-Leader,** Tanzania (June 2024): coordinated a two-week international outreach team
- **Self-funded my degree** through part-time hospitality work (Fancy Franks; Lourensford Wine Estate, 2022–2024), including leading a 22-person team at a high-profile event
- **Endurance sport:** Two Oceans Half Marathon finisher (2023, 2024), Warrior Race Black Level finisher, competitive cyclist